



The Morning Brief

MAY 4, 2026

Project Freedom

US Navy escort opens Hormuz traffic Monday as Trump rejects Iran's 14-point peace plan; Palantir tonight, AMD Tuesday, Disney Wednesday frame the week.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE) ~7,187 · Fresh ATH	BRENT (OVERNIGHT) Eased · Convoy begins	IBIT (PRE-MKT) \$44.47 · ↑2.65%	TECH (XLK PRE-MKT) ↑1.49% · AI-edge bid	FEAR & GREED 40 · Fear
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SECTION 01

Markets

RECORDS CARRY INTO A CONVOY MONDAY — PRE-MARKET TAPE SUGGESTS ENERGY-TO-AI ROTATION REVERSAL

Friday closed at fresh all-time highs near 7,187 on the S&P 500 per Yahoo Finance and CNBC compilations, completing a week defined by industrials/cyclicals leadership over the multiple-driven AI complex. The pre-market posture into Monday's open inverts that sequencing: tech (XLK) leads at +1.49% on the data drop, while energy (XLE -1.34%) and industrials (XLI -0.93%) trail as crude futures absorb the announcement of Trump's "Project Freedom" Hormuz escort operation per CNBC and Reuters reporting. CRDO is bid +5.96% in pre-market on continued read-across to the AI-data-center connector thesis, while SYK is indicated -6.47% as the post-earnings reassessment of the cyber-disruption Q1 miss extends. Carson's \$645.80 SPY support remains active and well above current levels, providing a wide retracement window if the Project Freedom narrative resolves more decisively than oil futures are currently pricing.

EARNINGS WEEK DEFINES THE MULTIPLE QUESTION — PALANTIR TONIGHT, AMD TUESDAY, DISNEY WEDNESDAY

Palantir reports today after the close with consensus EPS of \$0.28 on revenue of \$1.54B (+74% YoY) per TipRanks and Bitget compilations of analyst expectations. The internal split is what matters: roughly \$764M in government revenue (+57% YoY) and \$772M in commercial (+94% YoY), with US commercial growth carrying the multiple narrative on AIP adoption velocity. AMD follows Tuesday after the close with consensus near \$1.28-\$1.29 EPS on \$9.88B revenue (+33% YoY) per TradingKey and TipRanks compilations, with Instinct MI300/MI350 traction and TSM capacity allocation the principal Data Center signals. Disney reports Wednesday pre-market with \$1.49 EPS consensus on \$24.85B (+5% YoY) per Forex.com compilations — the streaming-margin and

ESPN-monetization commentary the principal read-through. The IOWN growth sleeve's direct exposure runs through AMD; the AI-edge read-across into MRVL, NXPI, KEYS, LRCX, and CRDO is the broader sleeve signal. Palantir's commercial print is the cleanest read on whether AI-software multiples can sustain ahead of mid-month NVDA.

MACRO CALENDAR FRONT-LOADED — FACTORY ORDERS, FED WILLIAMS, LOAN OFFICER SURVEY ALL PRINT TODAY

Factory Orders for March print at 10:00 AM ET with consensus +0.5% MoM versus 0.0% prior per the data drop, following last Tuesday's +0.8% advance durable-goods read per Census Bureau coverage. Fed President John Williams speaks at 12:50 PM ET — the first FOMC participant remarks since Wednesday's 8-4 dissent hold at 3.50-3.75%

per CNBC reporting on Powell's final scheduled press conference as chair. The Senior Loan Officer Survey releases at 2:00 PM ET, with credit-tightening trends the principal read-through to IOWN's rate-sensitive defensives (ATO, BKH, NEE, DGX) and financials-adjacent SYF and SUPV. Total Vehicle Sales also print with 16.0M consensus versus 16.3M prior. The longer view: ISM Services prints Tuesday 10:00 AM ET (April data), and the Warsh confirmation full-Senate vote is now on track for the week of May 11 per CNBC, Bloomberg, and Yahoo coverage of the Senate Banking Committee's 13–11 party-line advance. Powell's term as chair expires May 15.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	~7,187 · Fresh ATH · ↑0.99%
SECTOR PRE-MKT READ	XLK ↑1.49% leads · XLE ↓1.34% · XLI ↓0.93%
WTI / BRENT (OVERNIGHT)	USO ↓2.92% · BNO ↓2.15% · Project Freedom
CRDO / SYK (PRE-MKT)	CRDO ↑5.96% · SYK ↓6.47% indicated
CARSON'S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY \$645.80 support · Untested
THIS WEEK	PLTR (Mon) · AMD (Tue) · DIS (Wed) · ISM Services (Tue)

When the convoy begins, oil futures retreat, and the AI-edge complex bids in pre-market, the question for the IOWN committee is whether Palantir's commercial print can extend the multiple base before the energy-supply normalization compresses the integrated-energy thesis. Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics

PROJECT FREEDOM — US NAVY CONVOY TO FREE 800 STRANDED VESSELS BEGINS TODAY

President Trump announced Sunday that the US will launch a Hormuz convoy operation, dubbed Project Freedom, beginning Monday to escort approximately 800 commercial vessels flagged in countries unaffiliated with the conflict out of the Strait of Hormuz, which has been blockaded by Iran since April 13 per CNBC, Reuters, NBC News, and Axios coverage. CENTCOM materials cited by NBC and Axios indicate the operation will involve guided-missile destroyers, over 100 land- and sea-based aircraft, multi-domain unmanned platforms, and approximately 15,000 service members. Brent crude eased modestly in overnight trade per Al Jazeera, OilPrice, and CNBC reporting — a relatively muted reaction reflecting market skepticism that the operation resolves the structural blockade. The IOWN integrated-energy sleeve (CVX, VLO, OKE, CTRA, CNX) faces a two-sided readout: refining-margin support remains intact while crude futures price in normalization optionality, and the energy-equity ETFs are trailing in the pre-market data drop with XLE -1.34%. CVX trades \$190.63 (-1.39%) post-Friday's Q1 print after the company guided continued \$3B-\$4B cost-savings program execution per company materials.

IRAN'S 14-POINT PEACE PLAN REJECTED — TRUMP CALLS IT "UNACCEPTABLE" IN SUNDAY INTERVIEW

Iran submitted a 14-point response to the US war-end proposal through a Pakistani intermediary per NPR and Al Jazeera coverage of the Tasnim and Press TV releases, demanding the war end within 30 days, withdrawal of US forces from Iran's periphery, an end to the naval blockade, release of frozen assets, payment of reparations, lifting of sanctions, an end to fighting in Lebanon, and a new mechanism governing the Strait of Hormuz. Trump told Israel's Kan News in a Sunday interview that the proposal was not acceptable in its present form and indicated Washington could resume kinetic action if Tehran escalates per CGTN, Jerusalem Post, and Washington Times coverage. Iran has separately warned the US Navy to stay clear of Hormuz following the Project Freedom announcement per Reuters. Two incidents were reported through the weekend: a tanker hit by unknown projectiles off UAE's Fujairah and a bulk carrier reportedly attacked by small craft off Iran per UKMTO and Reuters reporting. The diplomatic posture is bifurcated: kinetic operations and convoy escorts proceed while the political resolution remains elusive. The IOWN defense exposure (LMT, GD) and energy refining sub-sleeve carry the principal forward sensitivity to a duration-extending standoff.

UAE FORMALLY EXITS OPEC MAY 1 — OPEC+ ADDS 188,000 BARRELS IN FIRST MEETING WITHOUT ABU DHABI

The United Arab Emirates formally exited OPEC and the broader OPEC+ alliance effective May 1 per Al Jazeera,

CNBC, and Wood Mackenzie coverage, ending a six-decade membership and removing the cartel's second-most-influential producer from coordinated supply policy. OPEC+ then announced Sunday a June production adjustment of 188,000 barrels per day — similar to the 206,000 bpd increases of March and April less the UAE share — with Algeria, Iraq, Kazakhstan, Kuwait, Oman, Russia, and Saudi Arabia signing the Sunday communiqué per CNBC and Bitget compilations of OPEC's release. The increase is largely symbolic given Hormuz remains effectively impeded; physical supply impact is nominal in the near term. The strategic implication is for 2027 and beyond: should Hormuz traffic normalize, the UAE retains roughly 1.6M bpd of spare production capacity outside the cartel framework — equivalent to approximately 1.5% of global supply — structurally weakening OPEC's pricing influence per Al Jazeera and Wood Mackenzie analysis. CL closed Friday at \$87.26 (+2.23%) on Q1 commentary indicating the company's emerging-markets exposure remains supportive per the company's deep-dive coverage. NTR closed at \$75.22 (-1.03%) as the fertilizer-policy framework from last Friday's administration plan continues to digest.

PROJECT FREEDOM	Begins Monday · ~15,000 service members · ~800 vessels (CENTCOM)
BRENT (OVERNIGHT)	~\$108 · Modestly lower · Muted reaction
IRAN 14-PT PLAN	Rejected by Trump on Sunday (Kan News)
HORMUZ INCIDENTS	Tanker off Fujairah · Bulk carrier off Iran (UKMTO)
UAE OPEC EXIT	Effective May 1 · OPEC+ ↑188K bpd Sunday
SPARE CAPACITY	UAE ~1.6M bpd outside cartel framework

On Our Radar

1. Palantir reports tonight after the close — the cleanest commercial-AI tape signal ahead of mid-month NVDA. Wall Street consensus per TipRanks and Bitget compilations sits at \$0.28 EPS (+115% YoY) on \$1.54B revenue (+74% YoY), with the internal split running roughly \$764M government (+57% YoY) and \$772M commercial (+94% YoY). The company has guided full-year 2026 revenue to \$7.182–\$7.198B (+61% YoY) with US commercial above \$3.144B (+115% YoY) per its prior commentary. Commercial-segment new logos and deal-size commentary are the principal narrative anchor — the multiple discipline question for the broader IOWN AI-edge sleeve (CRDO, MRVL, NXPI, KEYS, LRCX) hinges on whether the commercial growth trajectory accelerates or merely matches consensus. CRDO trades pre-market +5.96% on continued positioning into the data-center connector thesis; MRVL (\$164.95, –0.12% Friday close) and KEYS (+0.71% Friday) carry forward exposure. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. AMD reports Tuesday after the close — Instinct MI300/MI350 traction and TSM capacity allocation are the principal Data Center signals. Consensus from TradingKey and TipRanks compilations sits at \$1.28–\$1.29 EPS (+33% YoY) on \$9.88B revenue (+33% YoY), against AMD's own Q1 guidance of approximately \$9.8B revenue and 55% non-GAAP gross margin. Q4 2025 Data Center hit a record \$5.4B (+39% YoY). The export-control overhang remains in place: AMD's guidance includes only \$100M of MI308 sales to China, well below recent quarters per company commentary. AMD trades \$360.54 (+1.71%) in pre-market on the data drop. The growth-sleeve read-across into NVDA (currently \$198.45, –0.56% Friday) is the broader question — whether AI infrastructure capex can sustain the multiple while energy-supply premium compresses. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. Factory Orders, Fed Williams, and the Senior Loan Officer Survey print today — the front-loaded macro calendar feeds the Tuesday ISM Services release.

Factory Orders for March print at 10:00 AM ET with consensus +0.5% MoM versus 0.0% prior per the data drop, following the +0.8% advance durable-goods read released April 29 per Census Bureau coverage. New York Fed President John Williams speaks at 12:50 PM ET — the first FOMC participant remarks since Wednesday's 8–4 dissent hold, with the four hawks reportedly favoring removal of the easing bias per CNBC reporting on Powell's final scheduled press conference. The Senior Loan Officer Survey at 2:00 PM ET will frame the credit-tightening question that flows through SYF and SUPV. ISM Services for April prints Tuesday at 10:00 AM ET. TLT trades \$85.61 (–0.01%) on the data drop with PC of \$85.62, effectively flat — the long end has remained anchored despite the hawkish FOMC tilt. *Avoid Erosion.*

4. The CTRA exit from the S&P 500 lands Thursday May 7 — the Devon merger close coincides with the index rebalance.

S&P Dow Jones Indices announced Veeva Systems will replace Coterra Energy in the S&P 500 effective prior to Thursday's open per Stocktitan, Yahoo, and Benzinga reporting, with the all-stock \$58B Devon–Coterra combination targeted to close on or around May 7 per Devon's investor materials. CTRA shareholders receive 0.70 Devon shares per CTRA share at the close, materially reshaping the IOWN energy sub-sleeve's composition. CTRA closed Friday at \$35.91 (+0.64%) and is indicated –1.48% pre-market on the data drop ahead of the index-tracker rebalance window. The pro forma Permian operator targets pro forma production above 1.6M boe/d with \$1.0B annual pre-tax synergies per the merger announcement — the Delaware Basin consolidation read-through validates the broader IOWN energy weighting. *The physical world matters.*

5. The Warsh-to-Powell transition window opens this week — the full Senate vote is expected the week of May 11.

The Senate Banking Committee's 13–11 strict party-line approval per CNBC, Bloomberg, and Yahoo coverage tees up Warsh for the simple-majority full Senate vote, with Republicans holding 53 seats and Senator Fetterman indicating bipartisan support per Semafor. Powell's term as chair expires May 15, with Powell having confirmed at the FOMC press conference that he plans to remain on the Board of Governors after the chair handoff. The 8–4 dissent at last week's FOMC was the largest at a meeting since 1992 per CNBC reporting, suggesting institutional resistance to a Warsh-led pivot remains material. The IOWN dividend sleeve's rate-sensitive defensives (ATO, BKH, NEE, DGX) carry the principal forward sensitivity to the framing transition. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

6. Berkshire's Q1 result reinforces the discipline framing — cash above \$397B, operating profit \$11.35B (+18% YoY), Geico –34%,

Berkshire Hathaway's Q1 disclosure Saturday confirmed the cash pile at a record \$397B versus \$373B at year-end 2025 per Bloomberg, CNN, and IndexBox compilations of the company's release, with operating earnings of \$11.35B falling short of \$11.56B consensus despite the 18% YoY advance. Net income roughly \$10.1B doubled prior-year. Insurance underwriting contributed \$1.7B (+28% YoY), though Geico's 34% earnings decline drew the principal scrutiny. New CEO Greg Abel reaffirmed the anti-Bitcoin posture at Saturday's annual meeting per Yahoo Finance. The framing for the IOWN committee is consistent with the May 3 weekend brief's posture: when the largest single discretionary equity allocator holds \$397B in cash at fresh ATHs, the discipline question is selective deployment over chasing strength — the dividend sleeve's emphasis on cash-flow industrials and real-asset producers (CAT, GD, ADP, NEE, ATO, FAST) maps onto the same framework. **Avoid Erosion.**

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